

altairsim — examples

2026-10-01 · 43827d6

Machines that boot. Each directory here is self-contained: a `.toml` that describes the machine, the media it needs lying beside it, and a note saying what you will see. Copy any one of them anywhere and it still runs — a path inside a machine file resolves against **that file**, not against the directory you launched from.

In the release

These five examples come in the release package. Each folder holds a machine file, the media that it needs and a README that tells you what to type.

```
altairsim examples/cpm/cpm22-buffered.toml    # CP/M 2.2b on an 8" floppy
altairsim examples/cpm/cpm22-terminal.toml    # ...the same, console in a built-in VT100 window
altairsim examples/basic4k/basic4k.toml       # Altair 4K BASIC, off a 1975 cassette
altairsim examples/basic1/basic1.toml         # Altair BASIC 1.0, the first one, off a cassette
altairsim examples/debugger/debugger.toml     # a bench for learning the symbolic debugger
```

	What it is
<code>cpm/</code>	Mike Douglas's track-buffered CP/M 2.2b v2.3 , 56K, booted by the DBL PROM from an 8" floppy. <code>A></code> in one command. <code>cpm22-terminal.toml</code> boots the same disk with its console in a built-in VT100 window the simulator draws itself — no telnet client, no external emulator.
<code>basic4k/</code>	Altair 4K BASIC 3.1 read off a period <code>.tap</code> by the bootstrap that MITS shipped, unmodified: <code>MEMORY SIZE?</code> .
<code>basic1/</code>	Altair BASIC 1.0 , the first Altair BASIC, read off a period <code>.tap</code> by its own bootstrap. The bootstrap never jumps into BASIC, so you press <code>Ctrl-E</code> and type <code>RUN 0</code> , as an operator did in 1975: <code>MEMSIZ?</code> .
<code>debugger/</code>	A 46-byte program with its symbols and a guided walk through the monitor's debugger: <code>SYMBOLS LOAD</code> , symbolic <code>DISASM</code> , single-step, break on a label, run.
<code>ai-mcp/</code>	A working directory for an AI assistant driving altairsim over MCP : a CP/M machine and a tiny <code>HELLO.ASM</code> with one deliberate bug the assistant assembles, runs, single-steps to find, and fixes — all through the simulator's MCP tools. See <code>DRIVING-WITH-AI.md</code> , or the <code>altairsim</code> Agent Skill, which an assistant that reads skills loads by itself: <code>skills/altairsim/</code> in the package, <code>.claude/skills/altairsim/</code> in this repository.

More machines

More ready-to-run machines, with more documentation, are at <https://altairsim.com>. Each one has a README that says what it is and what to type.